Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel GCSE
In History (1HI0)
Paper P5 Period study

Option P5 Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

How to award marks when level descriptions are used

1. **Finding the right level**

The first stage is to decide which level the answer should be placed in. To do this, use a 'best-fit' approach, deciding which level most closely describes the quality of the answer. Answers can display characteristics from more than one level, and where this happens markers must use the guidance below and their professional judgement to decide which level is most appropriate. For example, one stronger passage at L4 would not by itself merit a L4 mark, but it might be evidence to support a high L3 mark, unless there are substantial weaknesses in other areas. Similarly, an answer that fits best in L3 but which has some characteristics of L2 might be placed at the bottom of L3. An answer displaying some characteristics of L3 and some of L1 might be placed in L2.

2. **Finding a mark within a level**

After a level has been decided on, the next stage is to decide on the mark within the level. The instructions below tell you how to reward responses within a level. However, where a level has specific guidance about how to place an answer within a level, always follow that guidance.

Levels containing two marks only

Start with the presumption that the work will be at the top of the level. Move down to the lower mark if the work only just meets the requirements of the level.

Levels containing three or more marks

Markers should be prepared to use the full range of marks available in a level and not restrict marks to the middle. Markers should start at the middle of the level (or the upper-middle mark if there is an even number of marks) and then move the mark up or down to find the best mark. To do this, they should take into account how far the answer meets the requirements of the level:

- If it meets the requirements *fully*, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for answers that are as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If it only *barely* meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for answers that are the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for answers that have a *reasonable* match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Indicative content

Examiners are reminded that indicative content is provided as an illustration to markers of some of the material that may be offered by students. It does not show required content and alternatives should be credited where valid.

P5 Period study: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

Question		
1(a)		Explain **one** consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950). **Target**: Analysis of second order concepts: consequence [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 2 marks. **AO1**: 2 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• Simple or generalised comment is offered about a consequence. [AO2] • Generalised information about the topic is included, showing limited knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
2	**3–4**	• Features of the period are analysed to explain a consequence. [AO2] • Specific information about the topic is added to support the explanation, showing good knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- The Law of Return increased Jewish immigration into Israel, resulting in the population of Israel almost doubling.
- The Law of Return allowed the IDF to increase in size as all Jewish citizens, which now included those who had immigrated, had to serve.
- Israel was unprepared for the large increase in immigration as a result of the Law of Return, leading to problems of homelessness, unemployment and social tensions.

Question		
1(b)		Explain **one** consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956). **Target**: Analysis of second order concepts: consequence [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 2 marks. **AO1**: 2 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• Simple or generalised comment is offered about a consequence. [AO2] • Generalised information about the topic is included, showing limited knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
2	**3–4**	• Features of the period are analysed to explain a consequence. [AO2] • Specific information about the topic is added to support the explanation, showing good knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- Nasser was credited with the withdrawal of the British and French from the Suez Canal, increasing his status in the Arab world.
- Israel had gained security and the reopening of the Tiran Straits meant they could trade again.
- The Suez Crisis brought greater Arab unity and nationalism, resulting in the establishment of the United Arab Republic in 1958, as the foundation of a pan-Arab state.

Question		
2		Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War (1967). You **may** use the following in your answer: • closing of the Tiran Straits • UN ceasefire You **must** also use information of your own. **Target**: Analytical narrative (i.e. analysis of causation/consequence/change) [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics) [AO1]. **AO2**: 4 marks. **AO1**: 4 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple or generalised narrative is provided; the account shows limited analysis and organisation of the events included. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the events is shown. [AO1]
2	**3–5**	• A narrative is given, showing some organisation of material into a sequence of events leading to an outcome. The account of events shows some analysis of the linkage between them, but some passages of the narrative may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is added, showing some knowledge and understanding of the events. [AO1]
3	**6–8**	• A narrative is given which organises material into a clear sequence of events leading to an outcome. The account of events analyses the linkage between them and is coherent and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the key features or characteristics of the events. [AO1] *No access to Level 3 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying no qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge and understanding.

The middle mark in Levels 2 and 3 may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- Egyptian president, Nasser, expelled UN forces from Sinai and closed the Straits of Tiran to Israeli ships over fears that Israel was going to attack.
- Israeli officials interpreted the US suggestion that they should take action to open the Straits, as a signal to go ahead with military action against Egypt.
- Israel's air force launched attacks on airfields in Egypt, Jordan and Syria, supported by ground troops, on 5 June.
- By 7 June, the IDF had taken full control of the Sinai desert from Egypt, and all of Jerusalem from Jordan, resulting in both Egypt and Jordan accepting the UN ceasefire.
- On 10 June, Israel took control of the Golan Heights and Syria accepted the UN ceasefire.
- Israel established itself as the dominant miliary power in the Middle East at the time, keeping control of the occupied territories.

Question		
3		Explain **two** of the following: • The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948-49) for the state of Israel. • The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt. • The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987-93) for the Palestinian issue. **Target**: Analysis of second order concepts: consequence/significance [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2**: 8 marks. **AO1**: 8 marks. **NB** mark each part of the answer separately (2 x 8 marks).
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	1–2	• A simple or generalised answer is given, showing limited development and organisation of material. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	3–5	• An explanation is given, showing an attempt to analyse importance. It shows some reasoning, but some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is added, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	6–8	• An explanation is given, showing analysis of importance. It shows a line of reasoning that is coherent and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1]

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1a; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in Levels 2 and 3 may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948-49) for the state of Israel.

Relevant points may include:

- As a result of its victory in the war, Israel gained control of a much larger area of what had been the British mandate of Palestine than had been proposed by the UN.
- Israelis gained control of West Jerusalem via an agreement with King Abdullah of Transjordan, and subsequently declared Jerusalem as the capital of the new state.
- The IDF, which had been created to defend Israel in the war, provided Israel with a level of preparedness for potential further wars with its Arab neighbours.
- The war did not result in a peace treaty, as the state of Israel's borders were not fully agreed to by neighbouring Arab states, despite armistice agreements made with each of them to stop the fighting.

The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt.

Relevant points may include:

- Kissinger put pressure on Israel to withdraw troops from the Suez Canal by threatening to stop US aid.
- Kissinger's diplomacy managed to get Israel and Egypt to withdraw troops from the Suez Canal and allow a UN peacekeeping force to be installed.
- Kissinger's 'shuttle diplomacy' allowed for the clearing of the Suez Canal of sunken ships so it could be reopened.
- Kissinger's 'shuttle diplomacy' resulted in Egypt and Israel agreeing to use diplomacy rather than war to settle future disputes.

The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue.

Relevant points may include:

- Many Palestinians felt empowered, as the Intifada created a new sense of unity, and no longer felt they had to rely on other Arab states for support.
- World media reports of the Intifada led to international pressure, especially from the USA, being put on Israel to change their 'Iron Fist' policy.
- Many Israelis began to believe that a diplomatic solution, instead of stronger military measures, had the potential to be more effective in achieving peace and security.
- In order to maintain his influence, Yasser Arafat announced the PLO would be renouncing violence and a two-state solution could be achieved.

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